TRANSLATOR'S PREFACE

The first edition of Gandhiji's *Autobiography* was published in two volumes, Volume I in 1927 and Volume II in 1929. The original in Gujarati which was priced at one rupee has run through five editions, nearly 50,000 copies having been sold. The price of the English translation (only issued in a library edition) was prohibitive for the Indian reader, and a cheap edition has long been needed. It is now being issued in one volume. The translation, as it appeared serially in *Young India*, had, it may be noted, the benefit of Gandhiji's revision. It has now undergone careful revision, and from the point of view of language it has had the benefit of careful revision by a revered friend, who, among many other things, has the reputation of being an eminent English scholar. Before undertaking the task, he made it a condition that his name should on no account be given out. I accept the condition. It is needless to say it heightens my sense of gratitude to him. Chapters 29–43 of Part V were translated by my friend and colleague Pyarelal during my absence in Bardoli at the time of the Bardoli Agrarian Inquiry by the Broomfield Committee in 1928–9.

MAHADEV DESAI

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